

TOWARDS THE PROW



▲ CARRONADE

Two powerful short-barrelled guns known as carronades were mounted on the forecastle. They were devastating at close range.



▲ HEAVY ANCHOR

The largest of the seven anchors weighed more than 4½ tons and required 144 men to raise it.



◀ FIGUREHEAD

Supported by two cupids, the royal coat of arms was topped by a crown and surrounded by the motto *Honi soit qui mal y pense* ("Shame on he who thinks evil of it").

▼ AT REST

Now restored to its pre-Trafalgar condition, the *Victory* sits in dry dock at Portsmouth, England. It is the oldest ship in the world that is still officially in naval service.



▲ RIGGING BLOCK

Ropes that raise, lower, and manipulate sails are known as running rigging. In total, the *Victory's* rigging used 768 blocks, or pulleys.



▲ PLATFORM

The top – a platform halfway up each mast – was used by the crew to access the sails. In battle, seamen stood on the tops to fire down on the enemy.



▲ JEER BLOCKS

One of the most complex areas of rigging is just below the top, where the lower yard is held in place using large pieces of wood called jeer blocks.